5.9 Meningitis

Assessment	Nursing Diagnosis	Plan / Expected Outcome	Nursing Interventions	Evaluation
Subjective • "My neck is stiff and light hurts my eyes." **Objective** • Temperature 39.4 °C • Neck stiff • Light hurts his eyes	**ACTUAL** **Hyperthermia** related to central nervous system infection as evidenced by fever and neck stiffness.	Temperature below 38 °C within 24–48 hours.	• Give IV antibiotics without delay, as prescribed. • Give antipyretics. • Watch temperature and neurological status. • Isolate him as policy requires.	Afebrile: **goal met**.
Subjective • Headache severe, 8/10 **Objective** • Light hurts his eyes • Grimacing	**ACTUAL** **Acute pain** related to meningeal irritation as evidenced by headache and photophobia.	Pain 3/10 or less.	• Make the room dark. • Give analgesia as prescribed. • Keep stimulation and visitors to a minimum. • Check pain regularly.	Pain controlled: **goal met**.
Subjective • *No specific complaint* **Objective** • Bacterial meningitis • Has had close contacts	**RISK** **Risk for infection (to others)** as evidenced by risk factors: droplet transmission.	Infection does not spread to contacts.	• Use droplet precautions as policy says. • Inform infection control. • Arrange prophylaxis for contacts as ordered.	No secondary cases: **goal met**.